

Checklist

Engineering Executive: Internal Communication

Maintain the Drip (Consistent Updates)

- ☐ Send a short, regular update (e.g., weekly), even if nothing major happened
- ☐ Include 1-2 human/personal sentences
- ☐ Add key reminders about upcoming deadlines
- ☐ Cover 2-3 important topics in short paragraphs
- ☐ Include a brief bulleted list of smaller updates
- ☐ Close with an invitation for questions and feedback

Extract the Kernel (Respond to Executive Feedback Effectively)

- ☐ Identify the underlying concern behind a question or suggestion
- ☐ Avoid getting stuck debating incidental details
- ☐ Confirm your understanding of the core issue explicitly
- ☐ Reframe discussion around the real problem (e.g., speed, priority, risk)

Test Before Broadcasting

- ☐ Identify if the message is significant or org-wide
- ☐ Share the draft with at least one trusted reviewer
- ☐ Ask specific individuals (not just a group) for feedback
- ☐ Ask reviewers to flag:

- ☐ Confusing areas
- ☐ Unintended tone
- ☐ Potential controversy
- ☐ Missing context
- ☐ Revise before sending broadly

Build the Packet (Structure Every Important Communication)

Summary Section

- ☐ Start with a concise summary (tl;dr)
- ☐ Clearly state:
 - ☐ What changed
 - ☐ Who it applies to
 - ☐ What action is required
 - ☐ Key dates
 - ☐ Where to find more information
 - ☐ How to ask questions

Canonical Source

- ☐ Link to a single source of truth (doc/wiki)
- ☐ Ensure it is up-to-date

Questions

- ☐ Provide a public place for questions (chat/email list)
- ☐ Name a contact person for private questions

Keep It Short

- ☐ Edit for brevity
- ☐ Remove unnecessary background
- ☐ Use bullets where possible

- ☐ Cut anything that doesn't support the main message

Use Every Channel

- ☐ Share important updates via email
- ☐ Share the same updates via chat
- ☐ Reinforce in team meetings
- ☐ Reinforce in larger org meetings (e.g., all-hands)
- ☐ Publish meeting minutes
- ☐ Maintain weekly notes
- ☐ Maintain a decision log
- ☐ Ensure at least one person on every team is informed

Final Quick Audit Before Sending Any Major Message

- ☐ Is it regular and predictable?
- ☐ Did I extract the real issue?
- ☐ Did someone review it?
- ☐ Does it have a clear summary?
- ☐ Is it concise?
- ☐ Is it shared across multiple channels?